Helmerich & Payne Inc. (HP)

Takeaways from Technology Day: Expanding Footprint and Differentiated Technology Provide Long-Term Growth Avenues

HP	12m Price Target: **$41.00**	Price: **$40.19**	Upside: **2.0%**

We attended an in-person Technology Day in Tulsa, Oklahoma with Helmerich & Payne (HP) on October 6th and 7th, 2026. Key participants included Mr. Trey Adams III (President & Chief Executive Officer), Mr. Todd Scruggs (SVP & Chief Financial Officer), Mr. Kris Nicol (Vice President Investor Relations), and leaders of the company's business segments. We returned incrementally positive on HP's potential long-term growth drivers through the company's differentiated technology and growth strategies, both in North America and internationally. With the continued expansion of the FlexRobotics systems and automation technologies, we see HP poised to gain market share with customers over the next several years as operators look for continued enhanced results. We also see potential for gross margin growth in North America and internationally, particularly in Argentina. Lastly, while we do expect variability in rig count in the Middle East from rig suspensions through portions of 2027, we view HP's differentiated technology and increasing footprint as potential long-term value drivers for the stock. We also highlight the company's 4FQ update which indicated the quarter tracking at the high end of the guided range.

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Key Data

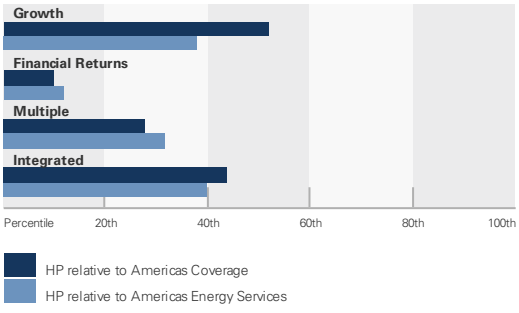
Market cap: $4.0bn
Enterprise value: $5.6bn
3m ADTV: $47.9mn
United States
Americas Energy Services
M&A Rank: 3

GS Forecast

	9/25	9/26E	9/27E	9/28E
Revenue ($ mn)	3,746.0	4,049.8	4,434.2	4,624.8
EBITDA ($ mn)	856.5	892.0	1,058.1	1,143.2
EBIT ($ mn)	2.4	187.1	446.6	553.0
EPS ($)	(1.65)	(0.57)	1.14	1.48
P/E (X)	NM	NM	35.3	27.2
EV/EBITDA (X)	5.0	6.2	5.0	4.4
FCF yield (%)	4.7	5.9	10.5	11.7
Dividend yield (%)	4.1	2.8	4.0	4.4
Net debt/EBITDA (X)	2.1	1.7	1.2	0.9

	6/26	9/26E	12/26E	3/27E
EPS ($)	0.76	0.23	0.26	0.26

GS Factor Profile



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.
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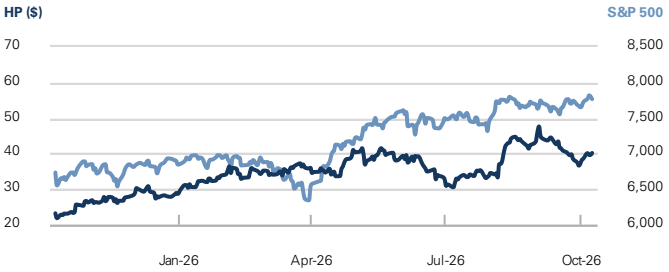
Ratios & Valuation

	9/25	9/26E	9/27E	9/28E
P/E (X)	NM	NM	35.3	27.2
EV/EBITDA (X)	5.0	6.2	5.0	4.4
EV/sales (X)	1.1	1.4	1.2	1.1
FCF yield (%)	4.7	5.9	10.5	11.7
EV/DACF (X)	6.8	7.6	7.0	6.5
CROCI (%)	5.5	5.8	6.1	6.2
ROE (%)	(5.7)	(2.1)	4.3	5.6
Net debt/EBITDA (X)	2.1	1.7	1.2	0.9
Net debt/equity (%)	64.0	58.5	48.9	37.9
Interest cover (X)	0.0	1.8	4.2	5.2
Inventory days	31.4	42.2	40.3	39.7
Receivable days	58.5	75.6	75.2	74.5
Days payable outstanding	25.1	26.2	23.7	26.4

Growth & Margins (%)

	9/25	9/26E	9/27E	9/28E
Total revenue growth	35.9	8.1	9.5	4.3
EBITDA growth	(26.1)	41.4	19.3	8.0
EPS growth	(147.4)	65.5	300.5	29.6
DPS growth	(40.5)	9.7	43.0	11.9
Gross margin	31.4	29.2	30.6	31.4
EBIT margin	0.1	4.6	10.1	12.0

Price Performance



	3m	6m	12m
Absolute	21.8%	13.7%	68.9%
Rel. to the S&P 500	17.4%	(0.7)%	46.9%

Source: FactSet. Price as of 8 Oct 2026 close.

Income Statement ($ mn)

	9/25	9/26E	9/27E	9/28E
Total revenue	3,746.0	4,049.8	4,434.2	4,624.8
Cost of goods sold	(2,568.4)	(2,869.0)	(3,076.0)	(3,173.5)
SG&A	(287.0)	(273.2)	(268.4)	(276.4)
R&D	(34.1)	(27.5)	(31.6)	(31.6)
Other operating inc./(exp.)	(262.4)	(11.0)	–	–
EBITDA	**627.5**	**887.2**	**1,058.1**	**1,143.2**
Depreciation & amortization	(625.1)	(700.2)	(611.5)	(590.2)
EBIT	**2.4**	**187.1**	**446.6**	**553.0**
Net interest inc./(exp.)	(72.6)	(93.0)	(97.4)	(97.4)
Income/(loss) from associates	(8.8)	5.3	7.3	6.6
Pre-tax profit	**(77.9)**	**85.0**	**356.5**	**462.2**
Provision for taxes	(85.8)	(141.7)	(242.7)	(314.6)
Minority interest	–	–	–	–
Preferred dividends	–	–	–	–
Net inc. (pre-exceptionals)	**(163.7)**	**(56.7)**	**113.8**	**147.5**
Net inc. (post-exceptionals)	**94.0**	**(39.6)**	**113.8**	**147.5**
EPS (basic, pre-except) ($)	**(1.65)**	**(0.57)**	**1.14**	**1.48**
EPS (diluted, pre-except) ($)	**(1.65)**	**(0.57)**	**1.14**	**1.48**
EPS (ex-ESO exp., dil.) ($)	**--**	**--**	**--**	**--**
DPS ($)	1.01	1.11	1.59	1.78
Div. payout ratio (%)	(61.5)	(195.9)	139.7	120.7
Wtd avg shares out. (basic) (mn)	99.3	99.8	99.9	99.9
Wtd avg shares out. (diluted) (mn)	99.4	99.9	100.0	100.0

Balance Sheet ($ mn)

	9/25	9/26E	9/27E	9/28E
Cash & cash equivalents	196.8	235.6	497.0	787.4
Accounts receivable	782.6	895.2	931.6	956.2
Inventory	324.3	338.6	341.5	348.6
Other current assets	161.7	170.8	170.8	170.8
Total current assets	**1,465.5**	**1,640.1**	**1,940.9**	**2,263.0**
Net PP&E	4,313.1	3,778.4	3,477.4	3,206.9
Net intangibles	668.4	606.1	606.1	606.1
Total investments	68.2	72.9	72.9	72.9
Other long-term assets	190.6	172.1	172.1	172.1
Total assets	**6,705.7**	**6,269.5**	**6,269.3**	**6,320.9**
Accounts payable	217.9	193.8	205.5	254.2
Short-term debt	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Current lease liabilities	–	–	–	–
Other current liabilities	596.9	593.1	593.1	593.1
Total current liabilities	**814.8**	**786.9**	**798.6**	**847.4**
Long-term debt	2,057.1	1,855.3	1,855.3	1,855.3
Non-current lease liabilities	–	–	–	–
Other long-term liabilities	1,004.5	960.6	960.6	960.6
Total long-term liabilities	**3,061.6**	**2,815.9**	**2,815.9**	**2,815.9**
Total liabilities	**3,876.4**	**3,602.8**	**3,614.5**	**3,663.2**
Preferred shares	–	–	–	–
Total common equity	**2,829.3**	**2,666.6**	**2,654.8**	**2,657.6**
Minority interest	–	–	–	–
Total liabilities & equity	**6,705.7**	**6,269.5**	**6,269.3**	**6,320.9**
BVPS ($)	28.50	26.71	26.57	26.59

Cash Flow ($ mn)

	9/25	9/26E	9/27E	9/28E
Net income	(159.9)	(49.7)	113.8	147.5
D&A add-back	625.1	700.2	611.5	590.2
Minority interest add-back	–	–	–	–
Net (inc)/dec working capital	(79.8)	(128.6)	(27.6)	17.0
Others	157.6	(13.4)	33.4	33.4
Cash flow from operations	**543.0**	**508.4**	**731.1**	**788.1**
Capital expenditures	(426.4)	(269.8)	(310.6)	(319.7)
Acquisitions	–	–	–	–
Divestitures	45.8	42.5	–	–
Others	291.3	113.4	–	–
Cash flow from investing	**(1,925.3)**	**(113.8)**	**(310.6)**	**(319.7)**
Dividends paid	(100.7)	(111.1)	(159.0)	(178.0)
Share issuance/(repurchase)	–	–	–	–
Inc/(dec) in debt	200.0	(200.0)	–	–
Others	8.9	(32.7)	–	–
Cash flow from financing	**108.2**	**(343.8)**	**(159.0)**	**(178.0)**
Total cash flow	**(1,233.9)**	**38.6**	**261.5**	**290.4**
Free cash flow	116.6	238.6	420.5	468.4
Free cash flow per share (basic) ($)	1.17	2.39	4.21	4.69

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.

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Takeaways from Management Meeting and Technology Day

Point 1. Technology and automation deployment enables increased market share and margin growth

We visited the company's FlexRig Machinery Center and Rig 918 in Tulsa, OK, where we were given a tour and demonstration of the robotics and technology HP has developed as the company focuses on continued rig automation. With the expansion of their FlexRobotics operations with Exxon to nine systems operating by late 2027, we see potential market share growth for HP over the long term as the company uses automation expertise to win incremental rig awards with customers. HP noted that the use of FlexRobotics drives down the planned cycle time by 20.5 days, and the rig and system can be installed within 4 days when deploying for a customer. With about one third of HP's fleet running with Tier 1 automation, we see the opportunity for increased commercialization of FlexRobotics on HP's rigs for customers to achieve enhanced results. We believe the utilization of performance contracts with customers as well as the increased deployment of FlexRobotics should aid in margin expansion.

Point 2. Updates on North America point to a constructive 4FQ result

Management noted continued commercial conversations with customers, both public and private, as operators focus on budgeting decisions for 2027. With HP's operational 4FQ update of expectations for North America margins and activity to be at the high end of the guidance ranges, we believe the company is well set up heading into the end of the year. HP currently has ~151 rigs operating in North America and has the ability to add an incremental 9-10 rigs at low additional capital spend, though is looking for improving terms. We see the current dynamics of private E&Ps adding activity continuing over the next several months as commodity prices stay elevated. HP noted the potential for additional rigs to be allocated to geothermal customers such as Fervo as well as the opportunity for additional rigs to be used in HP's international exposures, potentially tightening rig supply in US land.

Point 3. International regions such as Argentina and Middle East present long-term growth opportunities

We believe HP's international regions pose an out-sized area of growth for the company, as opportunities in Argentina, Australia, the Middle East, and other regions support long-term margins. HP noted their increasing rig count in Argentina, where long-term contracts with strong margins are supporting the International business towards the high-end of the 4FQ26 margin guide. As HP ramps to 15 rigs in the country over the near term, the company sees the potential for an increasing position in the country, as they are working with multiple operators, and sees supportive trends over the long term. Given the long-term nature of international contracts, we are constructive on HP's focus around increasing their international presence. In the Middle East, we are mindful of some variability in the international segment throughout FY2027, particularly in Saudi Arabia as operators there look to potential short-term suspensions. With this said, we view HP's footprint in region as a value driver over the long term. Looking ahead, we monitor for incremental color on pricing, mobilization costs and the long-term activity outlook of the international business.

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Valuation and Key Risks

Valuation: Our 12-month price target is $41 which is based on an average of the valuations implied by our target through-cycle ('27-'31) EV/EBITDA multiple of 5.0x and our target through-cycle ('27-'31) FCF yield of 13.0%.

Key risks: 1) upside/downside to activity levels, **2)** earlier/later pricing recovery, and **3)** changes in commodity prices.

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Growth is based on a stock's forward-looking sales growth, EBITDA growth and EPS growth (for financial stocks, only EPS and sales growth), with a higher percentile indicating a higher growth company. **Financial Returns** is based on a stock's forward-looking ROE, ROCE and CROCI (for financial stocks, only ROE), with a higher percentile indicating a company with higher financial returns. **Multiple** is based on a stock's forward-looking P/E, P/B, price/dividend (P/D), EV/EBITDA, EV/FCF and EV/Debt Adjusted Cash Flow (DACF) (for financial stocks, only P/E, P/B and P/D), with a higher percentile indicating a stock trading at a higher multiple. The **Integrated** percentile is calculated as the average of the Growth percentile, Financial Returns percentile and (100% - Multiple percentile).

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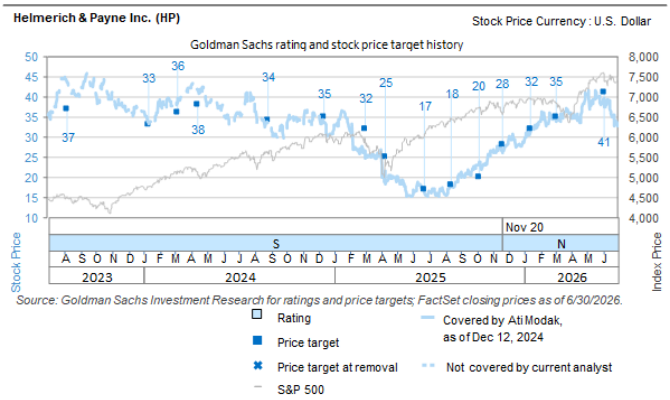
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Target price history table(s)

Helmerich & Payne Inc. (HP)

Date of report	Target price ($)	Closing price ($)
03-Jun-26	41.00	38.44
04-Mar-26	35.00	34.32
14-Jan-26	32.00	32.27
20-Nov-25	28.00	26.10
06-Oct-25	20.00	23.67
14-Aug-25	18.00	18.35
24-Jun-25	17.00	15.94
09-Apr-25	25.00	21.71
03-Mar-25	32.00	24.69
12-Dec-24	35.00	33.83
29-Aug-24	34.00	33.19
15-Apr-24	38.00	41.63
06-Mar-24	36.00	38.52
12-Jan-24	33.00	33.93

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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